This is yet another important characteristic of the population because the literacy rate of a country determines its economic structure and growth. Literacy, according to the 2001 Census, is the ability of a person of 7 years and above to read and write in any language. The census states the literacy rate of the population of India is almost 74.04% (2016).

Difficulty Level: Medium

16. Statement I: CORRECT—Adolescents are people between the age groups of 10-19 years and in our country. Also, about one-fifth of the population comprise adolescent individuals. They are especially relevant to the future growth and are the most significant part of the population of India.
    Statement II: CORRECT—The sex ratio of population is determined by the number of females for every 1000 males. This helps in understanding the equality of males and females in the society, which consequently gives an idea of the nation's culture. India's sex ratio has always been on the lower side, until recently. States like Kerala and Union Territory of Pondicherry have higher sex ratio than the major states.
17. Statement I: CORRECT—Literacy, according to the 2001 Census, is the ability of a person of 7 years and above to read and write in any language. The census states the literacy rate of the population of India is almost 74.04% (2016).
    Statement II: INCORRECT—The number of people in a population involved in different economic activities helps assess the growth of the country's economy. The occupational structure is the distribution of the population across different occupations. This is an important element of the population of India. Also, our occupational structure has three broad categories-
    - Primary occupation-agriculture, fishing, mining, animal husbandry, forestry, etc.
    - Secondary occupation- manufacturing, building, construction work, etc.
    - Tertiary occupation- communication, transportation, administration, etc.